Worked example · illustrative, based on the opening case of Confidently Wrong

The Dead Zone Matrix

Where does your decision sit? Score it on the four dimensions of the Algorithmic Readiness Index, the ARI.

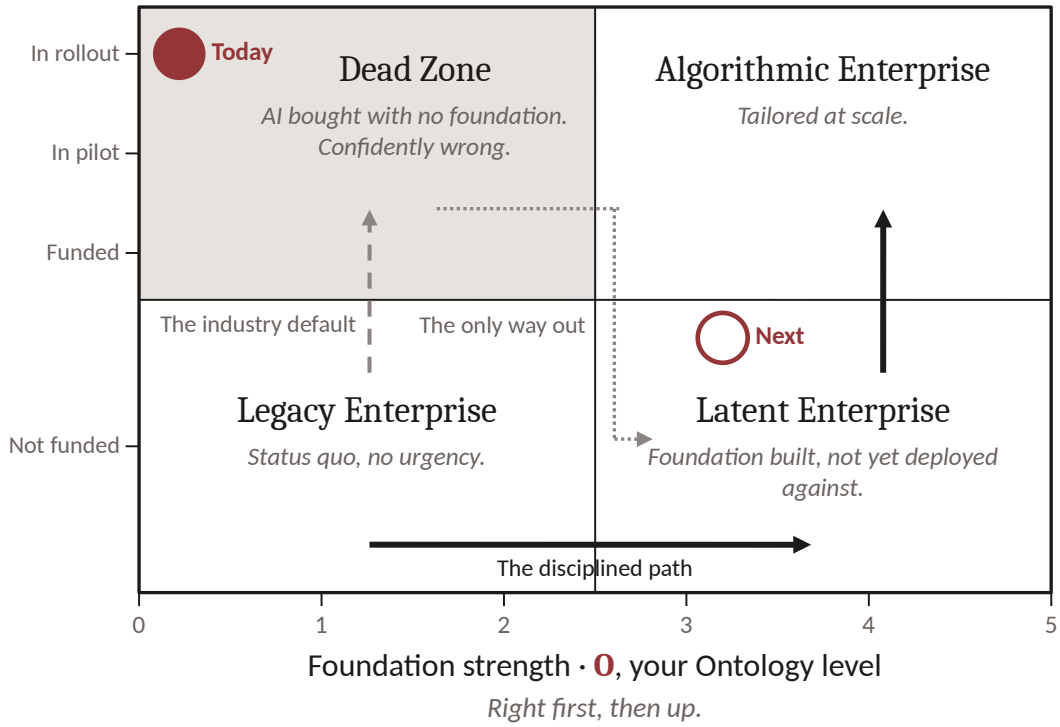
The decision

Renewal forecast for our largest customer

Scored by	Date	Version
CFO and service desk lead	Day one	1

Where you stand

Ontology places you on the matrix. The ARI tells you whether the quadrant is earned.



Mark where your decision sits today, and where the next step moves it.

The weakest dimension sets the ceiling.

Score the four dimensions

O	**Ontology** Do the systems that feed a decision agree on what things mean?	**0 0.0**	1 0.2	2 0.4	3 0.6	4 0.8	5 1.0
J	**Judgment** Does the same case get the same answer?	0 0.0	**1 0.2**	2 0.4	3 0.6	4 0.8	5 1.0
D	**Decision** How long from fact to decision, against what the decision can tolerate?	0 0.0	**1 0.2**	2 0.4	3 0.6	4 0.8	5 1.0
S	**Scale** Shaped to the customer's situation, or the same template for everyone?	0 0.0	**1 0.2**	2 0.4	3 0.6	4 0.8	5 1.0

0 absent · 1 ad hoc · 2 structured · 3 systematic · 4 optimized · 5 self-correcting

Breaks first

Ontology (Level 0 · 0.0)

The lowest dimension, and what it looks like today. If two tie, name both.

Four teams hold four versions of the same customer. The model blended them into 87%.

ARI = O × J × D × S, in decimals = **0.00**

Where the ARI lands

Dead Zone	Transition	Compounding
below 0.10	0.10 to 0.30	over 0.30

Three questions that put the doubt back

PEOPLE · Stakeholder Interview
Who loses most, and have you asked them yourself?

The sales lead. Not yet asked.

ASSUMPTIONS · Reasoning Record
What evidence would prove you wrong?

Falling usage and service tickets, already in our systems.

PERMISSION · Deployment Audit
If this causes a loss, who answers for it by name,
and is that person senior enough for it to hurt?

No name today. The board signed off on the dashboard number.

Use the ARI to find where decision architecture breaks. Pay nobody against it. Move the thresholds once you know where your own breaks fall.

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